



Elon backs Doge

Musk said that Dogecoin could ironically be the future of cryptocurrencies.
<http://digit.in/may21-66>



Still no aliens

Having looked at 60 million stars, Breakthrough Listen is yet to find any signs of Aliens. <http://digit.in/may21-67>

ASUS Expert Book B9400

Sets a new benchmark for business laptops

The ExpertBook B9400 is an ultra-portable business laptop powered by Intel's 11th generation i7 Tiger Lake CPU. It's got Iris Xe graphics and packs 16 GB of RAM. On paper, the laptops seem like it's kitted with powerful hardware to run almost anything you throw at it. The best part is that it packs all that in a chassis that weighs less than a kilogram.

DESIGN AND BUILD QUALITY

ASUS says the ExpertBook B9400 is the world's lightest 14-inch business laptop. They also state that the ExpertBook B9400 has passed MIL-STD 810G military-grade standards which means it's probably not going to give up on you if your usage is a little bit on the rough side.

With its distinct design and sharp edges, the ExpertBook B9400 also locks horns with some of our perennial favourites such as the HP Spectre and the Dell XPS series. The ExpertBook B9400 also has several novelties like the ErgoLift hinge and the NumberPad 2.0 feature. ErgoLift essentially lifts the laptop a little bit off the ground to open up more space for cooling and brings the keyboard up to a comfortable angle for typing.

DISPLAY

The ASUS Expertbook B9400 comes with a 14-inch FHD IPS panel with an anti-glare coating. The display is sharp and covers 100% sRGB colour space. Being an IPS panel, it also has great viewing angles

The ExpertBook B9400 has a peak brightness of 400 nits and a good contrast ratio which makes the black colours look even without any visible bleeding issues. Overall, the ExpertBook B9400 has a very good

display and could have done with a touchscreen.

PERFORMANCE

The Intel Core i7-1165G7 is touted to be one of the fastest Tiger Lake chips. In Cinebench R20, the ExpertBook B9400 managed to put out a score of 1810. The numbers are better than what we got on the HP Pavilion Laptop 13 running on the Intel Core i5-1135G7 CPU but we started noticing some thermal throttling.

The CPU starts to throttle down quite hard as soon as the temperature exceeds 90° C. On battery power, the CPU underclocked significantly and we were able to see the relevant performance dip in the benchmarks.

In PCMark 10 benchmark, the ExpertBook B9400 managed to score 4957, beating most other notebooks in our list including the HP ProBook Aero 635 G7 that's powered by the Ryzen 7 4700U. The ExpertBook B9400 did fall a little short on the PCMark 10's Digital Content Creation test, but that's not to say that you can't edit photos or videos on this laptop. Graphics are handled by the Intel Iris Xe iGPU, which is proven to be quite a reliable solution for most laptops. In 3DMark Fire Strike, we got a score of 4831 whereas it scored 1285 in 3DMark's Time Spy test.



Price
₹1,15,498

BATTERY LIFE

So how's the battery life of this laptop? Honestly, it's quite impressive. In fact, I'd say that the battery life is one of its strong points. On PCMark 10's battery test, the ExpertBook B9400 lasted for 839 minutes at peak brightness. 13+ hours on PCMark 10 is a very commendable score. It basically lasted longer than pretty much every other laptop that we've tested here at Digit.

KEYBOARD, TRACKPAD AND I/O

Despite the small form factor, the keyboard doesn't feel cramped. The keys also have sufficient tactile feedback and a good amount of travel.

The oversized touchpad on the laptop with the NumberPad 2.0 also makes for great

convenience especially for folks who like to work with large spreadsheets.

ASUS has also handled the port situation very well. On the left side, you get two USB-C 3.2 Gen2 ports with Thunderbolt 4, an HDMI port, and a micro HDMI port that can be used as LAN via the micro HDMI-to-RJ45 adapter that's included in the box. On the right side, you get an audio jack, a USB-A 3.2 Gen2 port, and a Kensington lock.

VERDICT

The ASUS Expertbook B9400 is ASUS' best ultrabook to date. It's impressive how the ExpertBook B9 doesn't compromise on any important aspect despite weighing as little as it does.

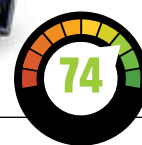
—Karthik Iyer

SPECIFICATIONS

PROCESSOR: Intel Core i7-1165G7 Processor 2.8 GHz (12M Cache, up to 4.7 GHz, 4 cores) | GRAPHICS: Intel Iris Xe Graphics | RAM: 16 GB LPDDR4X | STORAGE: 512 GB + 512 GB M.2 NVMe PCIe 3.0 RAID-1 SSD | DISPLAY: 14-inch FHD IPS anti-glare panel with 94% screen-to-body ratio | ASUS EXPERTBOOK B9400: Performance

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